IN HIS GLORY

Resources for the Journey

We Do Not Suffer Alone

A Guided Faith Journal for Adults Navigating Grief, Anger, and Surrender

"And the God of all grace, who called you to his eternal glory in Christ, after you have suffered a little while, will himself restore you and make you strong, firm and steadfast."

1 Peter 5:10

Psalm 139:14

This journal is not a program. It is not a checklist. It is an invitation — to be honest, to be still, and to let God meet you exactly where you are.

Each of the six parts mirrors a real stage of the journey from loss to surrender to peace. You may move through them in order, or you may find that one part speaks directly to where you are right now. There is no wrong way to begin.

Every section includes:

- A scripture anchor — the Word of God that speaks into that moment
- Reflection prompts — honest questions, not easy ones
- A writing activity — space to put what is in you onto the page

A note on names and credentials: they do not matter here. Yours does not, and ours does not. Only His does. Every "my" in this journal is meant to become "ours" — because you were never meant to carry this alone.

> "Praise be to the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of compassion and the God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our troubles, so that we can comfort those in any trouble with the comfort we ourselves receive from God."
>
> 2 Corinthians 1:3–4

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OUR TESTIMONY

The Story Behind This Journal

This resource was born out of suffering — and out of grace. We watched someone we loved face serious disease at such a young age, and it planted a seed of anger toward God that grew quietly for decades. Through those years, we searched for meaning and found only emptiness. At our lowest, with nowhere left to turn, we fell to our knees and asked for His mercy. That was the moment everything changed.

The loss that broke us open was a father's illness — open-heart surgery before one of us was even born, then a heart attack and triple bypass we witnessed as teenagers, and eventually his death. Grief has a way of making us angry at the One who could have stopped it. That anger is honest. God can hold it.

For years, a relationship with God felt impossible. Then came the breaking point — the moment when everything we had built to replace Him finally collapsed. We died to our old selves and refused to go another day without being in God's presence. That was twelve years ago.

We still struggle with anxiety and stress. That hasn't disappeared. But we no longer walk through it alone. Through Christ, confusion has become clarity, anger has become peace, and purposelessness has become a calling: to bring others to the same feet we fell to.

This journal exists for you — wherever you are. You may be in the anger. You may be in the wandering. You may be at your breaking point. All of it is welcome here. God is already in the room.

To God be all the glory. In the name of the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. Amen.

PART ONE

The Weight of Loss

For those who have watched someone suffer, or faced their own breaking point

"The Lord is close to the brokenhearted and saves those who are crushed in spirit."

Psalm 34:18

Loss reshapes us. Whether it is the death of a person, the death of a dream, or the slow erosion of a life we thought was secure — grief changes the ground beneath our feet. And often, it produces anger. Anger at circumstances. Anger at ourselves. Anger at God.

That anger is not a sin. It is an honest response to a world that is not as it should be. God is not frightened by your anger. He invites it. The Psalms are full of it. Bring what is real.

Reflection Prompts

— What have you lost? Name it as specifically as you can — a person, a relationship, a version of your life.

— What emotions has that loss produced in you? Be honest, even if the emotions feel wrong or shameful.

— Who or what are you blaming? God? Yourself? Someone else?

— Have you allowed yourself to grieve, or have you been pushing it down?

Activity: A Letter to God

Write an honest, uncensored letter to God about your loss. No filter required. He already knows what is in you — this is about you knowing it too. Tell Him what you lost. Tell Him how it made you feel. Tell Him if you are angry at Him.

Write here:

PART TWO

The Years of Wandering

For those who walked away, or never found their way in

> "But while he was still a long way off, his father saw him and was filled with compassion for him; he ran to his son, threw his arms around him and kissed him."
>
> Luke 15:20

Most of us have wandering years — seasons when we looked for meaning in work, achievement, relationships, or control. Sometimes the wandering looks successful from the outside. The emptiness lives on the inside.

The Prodigal Son did not wander into a ditch immediately. He had money, freedom, and plans. It was only when the resources ran out that he "came to himself." The Father did not wait for him to arrive at the door — He ran to meet him while he was still a long way off. That is who God is.

Reflection Prompts

— When did you feel most lost? What were the circumstances?

— What were you searching for in the wrong places — control, approval, success, numbness?

— Was there a moment you realized the emptiness, even if you couldn't name God as the answer yet?

— What kept you from turning toward God during those years?

Activity: Map Your Wandering Years

Without shame, map the seasons when you were wandering. What were you chasing? What were you running from? Write it out honestly. This is not a confession — it is a map of how far He came to find you.

Write here:

PART THREE

The Breaking Point

The moment everything collapsed — and the moment grace appeared

> "My grace is sufficient for you, for my power is made perfect in weakness."
>
> 2 Corinthians 12:9

The breaking point is rarely chosen. It arrives when the structure we have built — the identity, the control, the plan — can no longer hold the weight of what we are carrying. It is the moment we run out of ourselves.

What feels like destruction is often the mercy of God. He allows us to reach the end of our own strength so that His strength can begin. This is not punishment. This is grace.

Reflection Prompts

— What was your breaking point? What finally gave way?

— What did surrender feel like in that moment — terror, relief, grief, something else?

— If you have not yet hit a breaking point, where are you carrying weight that was never yours to carry?

— What did God meet you with in that moment — even if you couldn't name it then?

Activity: Write the Moment

Write the moment you fell to your knees — literally or figuratively. If it hasn't happened yet, write the moment you sense God is inviting you toward. What did you say? What did you feel? What changed?

Write here:

PART FOUR

Dying to the Old Self

What it means to be made new — not fixed, but transformed

> "We were therefore buried with him through baptism into death, in order that, just as Christ was raised from the dead through the glory of the Father, we too may live a new life."
>
> Romans 6:4

Transformation is not improvement. God does not take the old self and polish it. He buries it and raises something new. This can feel like loss — because it is. The old identity, the old coping mechanisms, the old version of who we were: they have to go.

But what rises is not less. It is more fully what we were always made to be. The new self is not a stranger — it is the truest version of you, freed from everything that was crushing it.

Reflection Prompts

— What did you leave behind when you surrendered to God? What had to die?

— What has God replaced it with — even imperfectly, even still in process?

— Where are you still holding onto the old self? What makes it hard to let go?

— Who are you becoming? How is that different from who you were?

Activity: Before and After

Draw a line down the center of the writing space. On the left: who were you before? On the right: who are you becoming? Be specific and honest. This is not about perfection — it is about direction.

Write here:

PART FIVE

Peace That Passes Understanding

Living with anxiety and stress — but not alone

> "Do not be anxious about anything, but in every situation, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus."
>
> Philippians 4:6–7

Surrender does not end the struggle. Anxiety and stress do not disappear at the moment of conversion. The difference is that we no longer carry them alone, and we no longer carry them without hope.

The peace God offers is not the absence of difficulty. It is a guarded heart — a heart that is held from within, even while the storm continues outside. This peace is not earned. It is received.

Reflection Prompts

— Where do you still struggle with anxiety or stress today?

— What does it feel like to bring that struggle to God rather than carrying it alone?

— Have you experienced a moment of peace that you could not explain? Describe it.

— What do you need to surrender to God today — right now, in this moment?

Activity: Your Surrender Prayer

Write a daily surrender prayer in your own words. Not a formal prayer — a conversation. Name the specific things you are anxious about. Hand them over. Return to this prayer whenever the weight returns.

Write here:

PART SIX

Your Testimony Belongs to Others

Changing every ‘my’ to ‘ours’ — sharing what God has done

“They triumphed over him by the blood of the Lamb and by the word of their testimony.”

Revelation 12:11

Your suffering was never only yours. The story God has written in your life — the loss, the wandering, the breaking, the rising — is a word of life for someone else who is still in the middle of their story.

Testimony is not performance. It is not a polished speech. It is the honest account of what God has done. Your credentials do not qualify you to share it. His grace does.

Reflection Prompts

— Who in your life needs to hear your story right now?

— What has kept you from sharing it?

— What is the one thing you most want someone in pain to know — from your own experience?

— How might your suffering become someone else’s hope?

Activity: Write Your Testimony

Write your condensed testimony — 3 to 5 sentences. Change every “my” to “ours”. Give all the glory to God. This is not about what you did — it is about what He did through your suffering.

Write here:

CLOSING

A Commissioning Prayer

Lord, we came to this journal carrying things that were never ours to carry alone. We brought our losses, our wandering, our anger, and our fear. You met us here. You always do.

Now send us out with what you have restored in us. Make us strong, firm, and steadfast — not in our own strength, but in yours. Let the suffering we have carried become comfort for someone still in the middle of theirs.

We give you all the glory. Not some of it. All of it.

"And the God of all grace, who called you to his eternal glory in Christ, after you have suffered a little while, will himself restore you and make you strong, firm and steadfast."

1 Peter 5:10

In the name of the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.

Amen, Amen, and Amen.

Continue your journey at Wonderfully Made Labs
In His Glory: Resources for the Journey — Psalm 139:14

